Data Leak Analysis Worksheet

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1. Identify the Issue(s)

The data leak resulted from several access-control and handling mistakes. A manager did not revoke a former or no-longer-needed user's access to a shared folder. A sales representative accidentally shared the entire folder instead of only the promotional materials intended for the partner. The partner then posted the link publicly, exposing information beyond the intended audience.

2. Review the Relevant Security Control

NIST SP 800-53 control AC-6, *Least Privilege*, states that users should be granted only the access and permissions necessary to perform their assigned tasks. Applying least privilege limits unnecessary access to sensitive information and reduces the chance that data will be viewed, changed, or shared by people who do not need it.

3. Recommendations

- Restrict access to sensitive folders and files based on job responsibilities and need-to-know. Share only the specific materials required for a task, rather than an entire folder.
- Review folder permissions regularly and promptly revoke access that is no longer needed, including access held by former employees or external partners.

4. Justification

These recommendations implement least privilege by reducing the number of people who can access confidential information and limiting what each person can reach. Regular permission reviews remove stale access, while sharing only the required files reduces the impact of accidental sharing. Together, these steps lower the risk of unauthorized disclosure.

Key control: NIST SP 800-53 AC-6 — Least Privilege